

Flower Dedication

The flowers adorning the sanctuary this morning are given in memory of our grandmother “L” on her 75th birthday.
— John, Annie, Attie, & Lamar Stanley

Announcements

FPC Membership Class. This 4-week series is a vehicle for learning more about the Christian faith and First Presbyterian Church. Membership not only entails “who” we are, but also “what” we believe and “how” we are to serve. We will discuss the larger denomination the church is a part of, specific theological foundations, and what it means to be a part of the Body of Christ at First Presbyterian Church. The class meets Sunday mornings — October 18 & 25, November 1 & 8 — at 9:30 a.m. in the Fellowship Hall (on the NE corner of the campus). If you have any questions or need more information, please contact the church office.

New Sunday School Class. A new Sunday school class entitled “America’s Providential History” will begin Sunday, November 1. It will be a 6-month class led by Richard Hendrick. Please call the church office and register by paying **\$25 (cost of book) by October 14.**

Samaritan’s Purse Shoeboxes. Collection boxes are available in the children’s wing and the side entrance by the church office. You can participate by shopping and collecting items, or by donating monetarily — each shoebox costs \$10 to ship. Items needed: small composition notebooks, pencils, small cars/trucks, puzzles, jump ropes, hair bows/barrettes/brushes/combs, underwear in larger sizes, and small stuffed animals. No liquids, candy, or food!

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Dr. Micah Monaghan
Greeters — Adam & Emory Kirk
Acolytes — Swayze Fisher & Julianne Whittington
Circle of Prayer — Johnny & Jill Taylor
AV Engineer — Russell Smith

Ushers — Bubba Labas, Randy Lambert, Alan Smith, & Henry Labas
Nursery — Ashley Majors, Katy Stanley, Penny Long, Suzanne Davis, Terre Smith, Abbie Butler, & Courtney Taylor

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor
Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship
Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care
Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries
Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women’s Min. & Comm.

Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director
Jan Pike - Choir Director
Malechi Doren - Accompanist
Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant
Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

October 11 Deacons’ Meeting
October 11 Bridal Shower for Emma Williams — Youth House, 1:00–2:30 p.m.
October 18 Bow-Making Class, 3:30 p.m.
October 22 Joy Riders Trip to Dixon Gardens in Memphis

Online Giving



Scan to give online



FIRST PRESBYTERIAN
CHURCH

October 11, 2026

Twentieth Sunday after Pentecost

“To be disciples, to make disciples”

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew, or scan the QR code and submit it on your phone. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

There is no Children’s Church this week during the school break, but members of our congregation will lead “A Word for the Children” during the service. Children are always welcome in worship! Children’s bulletins and crayons are available in the Narthex and at the East entrance.

Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. If you have a newborn and/or are nursing your baby, please feel free to use our baby room just off the narthex — a quiet space with comfortable seating where the worship service is broadcast as well.

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God’s Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by “Being Disciples and Making Disciples.”

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Outline

“Restored by Grace: Evidence of Repentance”

Rev. Waring Porter · Ezra 10:1–17

Something we learned recently on our hike to LeConte Lodge is that sometimes the hardest part of a hike isn’t getting to the top — it is getting back down. Going down the mountain requires another kind of effort, and different muscles. You have to pay attention to every step, and deal with the consequences of the climb.

In Ezra 9–10, we are reading about the repentance of God’s people. Repentance can be like walking down a mountain — it can be hard. There can be a moment when God opens our eyes to our sin and brokenness, and we see it clearly. We say, “Lord, I have sinned.” But then comes the question: What are you going to do about it? Ezra 10 gives us the evidence of repentance. Ezra 10 shows us that genuine repentance produces obedience... there is evidence of repentance. Let’s observe how this is worked out in this passage.

I. Repentance Begins with a Broken Heart (vv. 1–3)

II. Repentance Moves to Obedience (vv. 3–12)

III. Repentance Perseveres (vv. 13–17)

Resources: Matthew Henry’s Commentary, Vol. 2, Matthew Henry; Ezra & Nehemiah, Derek Kidner; Ezra & Nehemiah, Jacob M. Myers; Westminster Confession of Faith

*Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below;
Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.*

Children are invited to come forward as we prepare our hearts to hear God's Word.

G.T. & Sally Beth McCullough

Ezra 10:1–17 · Pew Bible, p. 396

Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field;
All: *The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever.*
Amen.

Rev. Waring Porter

SENDING

“I Surrender All”

God's people are blessed by the Lord and sent forth into the world, bearing with them the hope and peace of the Gospel. This should remind us that God doesn't just meet with us when we gather, but He goes with us as we scatter. As we continue our worship, we do so as people sent to our community for reconciliation, bearing witness to the good news of the gospel.

“Go Now in Peace”

* Indicates congregation standing if able

Our worship is a covenant conversation between God and His people. Throughout the service, God graciously speaks to us through His Word, and we joyfully respond with praise, confession, prayer, faith, thanksgiving, and obedience.

The prelude provides a quiet moment to prepare for worship. As the music begins, we are encouraged to calm our hearts, focus our minds, and enter reverently into God's presence.

“Make me to know your ways, O Lord; teach me your paths. Lead me in your truth and teach me, for you are the God of my salvation; for you I wait all the day long.”

“In Your House”

Leader: Come, let us worship the LORD, whose ways are higher than ours and whose mercy is greater than our sin.

One distinctive feature of Christian worship is that we lift our voices together. Our singing expresses both our love for God and our delight in the good news of the gospel. When we sing songs that are rich in truth and accessible to all, our attention is lifted from the wonder of creation to the greater wonder of the Creator. Scripture calls us to sing praises, and while musical skill is not required, hearts united in truth and offered with sincerity and joy are pleasing to God.

“Come, Thou Fount”

INVOCATION
The word “invocation” suggests that the congregation calls upon God, yet this must not be misunderstood to mean that we bring God into our presence or that His nearness depends on our request. The Lord is already present with His people before our worship begins. To “invoke” is to call upon or earnestly seek. So, we lift our voices to God, asking Him to draw near and enable us to worship Him rightly for His character and mighty works.

*Prayer of Invocation & The Lord’s Prayer

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

*The Psalter Reading: Psalm 25:6–15

Remember your mercy, O Lord, and your steadfast love, for they have been from of old. Remember not the sins of my youth or my transgressions; according to your steadfast love remember me, for the sake of your goodness, O Lord!

Good and upright is the Lord; therefore he instructs sinners in the way. He leads the humble in what is right, and teaches the humble his way. All the paths of the Lord are steadfast love and faithfulness, for those who keep his covenant and his testimonies.

For your name’s sake, O Lord, pardon my guilt, for it is great. Who is the man who fears the Lord? Him will he instruct in the way that he should choose. His soul shall abide in well-being, and his offspring shall inherit the land. The friendship of the Lord is for those who fear him, and he makes known to them his covenant. My eyes are ever toward the Lord, for he will pluck my feet out of the net.

Corporate Prayer of Confession

Gracious and merciful God, we confess that we have often followed our own ways rather than walking in your ways. We have trusted our own wisdom instead of your Word and pursued our own desires instead of your will. Forgive us for our sins and our wandering hearts. Give us humble hearts that are willing to be taught, and lead us in your truth. Turn us from our sinful ways and restore us by your grace. We thank you that you are merciful and gracious, and that through Jesus Christ you do not deal with us according to our sins. Help us to walk faithfully in your ways and live for your glory. In the name of Jesus Christ we pray.

Silent Confession

*Assurance of Divine Pardon: Psalm 103:8–12

“The Lord is merciful and gracious, slow to anger and abounding in steadfast love. He will not always chide, nor will he keep his anger forever. He does not deal with us according to our sins, nor repay us according to our iniquities. For as high as the heavens are above the earth, so great is his steadfast love toward those who fear him; as far as the east is from the west, so far does he remove our transgressions from us.”

*Gloria Patri

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son: and to the Holy Ghost; As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be: world without end. Amen.

Sacrament of Infant Baptism

*Allan Spencer Lee III & Nash Withers Lee
Children of Spencer & Georgia Lee*

*Song of Blessing: “Jesus Loves You”

Jesus loves you, this we know, for the Bible tells us so; Little ones to Him belong, you are weak but He is strong. Yes, Jesus loves you! Yes, Jesus loves you! Yes, Jesus loves you! The Bible tells us so.

ASSURANCE OF PARDON
After confessing our sins, we hear God’s promise of forgiveness, reminding us that the good news of Jesus Christ meets our confession with grace. We are reminded that true repentance is always answered by God’s faithful forgiveness, and Christ’s saving work is greater than our sin.

INFANT BAPTISM
We believe infant baptism is a sign and seal of God’s covenant of grace, marking the children of believers as members of the visible church just as circumcision did under the old covenant. It does not guarantee salvation, but it signifies God’s promises and calls the child to personal faith and repentance as they grow. (Gen. 17:7–12; Col. 2:11–12)

WORD

Every Member Canvass

*Mr. Peter Fisher
Vice-Chairman*

“But as you excel in everything — in faith, in speech, in knowledge, in all earnestness, and in our love for you — see that you excel in this act of grace also.” *2 Corinthians 8:7*

The Giving of Tithes and Offerings

The Offertory